

SpaceX только что вывела на орбиту 10 000 спутников Starlink, и небо становится всё более тесным

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SpaceX преодолела впечатляющий рубеж: на орбите одновременно работают более 10 000 спутников Starlink.

Это событие произошло после запуска ракеты Falcon 9 с базы Космических сил США на мысе Канаверал в Калифорнии в конце марта — начале апреля 2026 года, когда компания вывела на низкую околоземную орбиту еще 25 спутников. Это выдающееся достижение в области промышленной скорости, а также тревожный сигнал для астрономов и экспертов по космической безопасности, которые говорят, что наиболее активно используемый диапазон частот в космосе начинает напоминать пробку в час пик.

За громкими цифрами стоит реальность, с которой могут сравниться лишь немногие конкуренты: SpaceX производит, интегрирует и запускает спутники практически со скоростью конвейера. Но по мере того, как растет количество спутников, возникают вопросы о том, кому будет принадлежать ночное небо и не слишком ли много спутников будет на орбите.

Запуск с космодрома Ванденберг позволил Starlink вывести на орбиту более 10 000 активных спутников

Sommaire

- 1 Запуск с космодрома Ванденберг позволил Starlink вывести на орбиту более 10 000 активных спутников
- 2 По данным независимого трекера, на орбите находится 10 020 спутников Starlink
- 3 Многократность Falcon 9 — залог рекордных темпов SpaceX
- 4 По данным Starlink, у компании 10 миллионов клиентов, и она не собирается останавливаться на достигнутом
- 5 Астрономы предупреждают, что ночное небо и низкая околоземная орбита быстро меняются
- 6 Основные выводы
- 7 Часто задаваемые вопросы
 - 7.1 Почему говорят о 10 000 «активных» спутников, а не просто о запущенных?
 - 7.2 Сколько спутников Starlink находится на орбите после запуска 17 марта 2026 года?
 - 7.3 Какую роль в расширении Starlink играет возможность повторного использования ракеты Falcon 9?
 - 7.4 Действительно ли Starlink доминирует по сравнению с другими группировками спутников?
 - 7.5 Какие основные претензии связаны с растущим количеством спутников?
- 8 Источников

 Français

Миссия под названием Starlink Group 17-24 стартовала с космодрома Ванденберг с площадки 4E. На борту было 25 спутников — такое количество уже стало привычным для SpaceX, но не перестало быть символическим. Благодаря этому запуску компания преодолела рубеж в 10 000 одновременно активных спутников Starlink.

Первая ступень ракеты-носителя Falcon 9, использованная в этом полете и известная как B1088, совершила свой 14-й полет, после чего вернулась на Землю и совершила посадку на беспилотный корабль SpaceX «Я все еще люблю тебя» в Тихом океане. Это не просто крутой трюк, а основа темпа запусков SpaceX. Без возможности повторного использования частота и стоимость запусков кардинально изменились бы.

Это была 27-я миссия SpaceX по запуску спутников Starlink в 2026 году, которая показала, как растет сеть: не скачкообразно, а благодаря регулярным запускам, которые происходят почти каждую неделю. Наблюдатели за отраслью часто отмечают, что секрет успеха — в повторяемости: каждая миссия очень похожа на предыдущую, что помогает снизить риски.

SpaceX had already launched a “10,000th” Starlink satellite in cumulative terms earlier in the program. The difference now is that the company has more than 10,000 still up there and working at the same time, despite routine replacements, satellites intentionally deorbited, and occasional failures.

An independent tracker puts the total at 10,020 Starlinks in orbit

Independent tracking matters in space, where marketing claims can outpace reality. Astrophysicist Jonathan McDowell, widely cited for his meticulous cataloging of objects in orbit, estimated that SpaceX had 10,020 Starlink satellites in orbit after the California launch.

Since May 2019, SpaceX has sent 11,529 Starlink satellites into space. Not all of them are still there. Starlink is designed more like a fleet than a set-it-and-forget-it infrastructure project: satellites have a typical lifespan of about five years before being replaced and guided back into Earth’s atmosphere to burn up.

One statistic captures how dominant Starlink has become: the constellation is estimated to account for roughly two-thirds of all active satellites currently in orbit. In other words, on any given day, Starlink is most of the traffic.

And “in orbit” doesn’t always mean “working.” But trackers generally find that the vast majority of Starlink satellites are operational at any given time, with only a small number offline, good news for customers, and a bigger governance headache for everyone else sharing low Earth orbit.

Falcon 9's reusability is the engine behind SpaceX's record pace

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Starlink's growth is inseparable from Falcon 9 and SpaceX's relentless push to reuse hardware. Falcon 9 has now surpassed 600 launches, an unmatched run for a modern orbital rocket, and that repetition compounds into experience, standardized procedures, and a supply chain tuned for volume.

The B1088 booster's 14th flight is a snapshot of that model. Drone-ship landings in the Pacific and Atlantic have become operational routine, but they're also a potential choke point: a failed recovery can slow the pipeline even if the satellites reach orbit.

SpaceX has previously deployed as many as 60 Starlink satellites on a single mission, showing how much capacity it can bring to bear when needed. The 25-satellite load from Vandenberg was smaller, and the company also launched another batch the same day from Florida, evidence of a multi-coast operation that functions like a production network, not a one-off launch provider.

The gap with rivals is stark. OneWeb, often cited as the other major satellite-internet constellation, has 654 satellites. That's not just a difference in size; it's a different business model. SpaceX builds the satellites, launches them on its own rockets, and operates the service, speedy, vertically integrated, and increasingly influential.

Starlink says it has 10 million customers, and it's not done expanding

Starlink isn't just a space spectacle; it's a massive consumer and enterprise internet business. The company says it topped 10 million customers worldwide in February 2026, up from 9 million in December 2025, growth that suggests demand well beyond rural "dead zones," even if remote coverage remains a core pitch.

The system relies on low Earth orbit satellites beaming internet to ground terminals, delivering lower latency than traditional geostationary satellites, an edge that matters for video calls, online gaming, and many work-from-anywhere setups. Starlink says it's available in roughly 150 countries and territories, helping explain the global surge.

SpaceX's current roadmap targets about 12,000 satellites, with longer-term plans discussed in the industry that could reach as high as 34,400. Some of the next-generation satellites are planned for orbital shells around 525 to 535 kilometers up, about 326 to 332 miles above Earth. Those altitudes aren't trivia; they shape how many objects share the same lanes and how often satellites must maneuver to avoid each other.

More satellites also doesn't automatically mean better service everywhere. Performance depends on ground infrastructure, radio-frequency congestion, traffic prioritization, and pricing policies. Many users report dramatic improvements in isolated areas, while others describe speed swings depending on time of day and local demand.

Astronomers warn the night sky, and low Earth orbit, are changing fast

Crossing 10,000 active satellites isn't just a record. It's a shift in the environment above our heads. Space-debris experts have warned for years that crowding in low Earth orbit raises the risk of collisions, events that can create clouds of debris and threaten other spacecraft.

Astronomers have a more visible complaint: satellites can streak across telescope images, wiping out data. Researchers say this isn't about aesthetics, it's about losing observations, especially for

wide-field surveys that scan large swaths of sky.

Starlink's short satellite lifespan also means constant churn. With an average life of about five years, the system requires regular deorbiting and replacement, driving a steady stream of launches. Tracking data suggests more than 1,500 Starlink satellites launched since 2019 have already reentered the atmosphere. That's helpful for limiting dead hardware in orbit, but it also confirms the program's permanent replenishment cycle.

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The biggest unresolved issue may be concentration of power. When one company accounts for roughly 65% of active satellites, coordination becomes political: who sets the rules for maneuvering, traffic priority, and technical standards? Regulators can write frameworks, but SpaceX's speed keeps stress-testing the system.

SpaceX has made changes over time, like tweaks intended to reduce brightness and improve tracking coordination, but sheer scale changes the math. As Starlink pushes toward 12,000 satellites and beyond, public acceptance may become as critical as rocket reliability.

Key Takeaways

- SpaceX crossed the threshold of 10,000 active Starlink satellites after a launch from Vandenberg on March 17, 2026.
- The total in orbit is estimated at 10,020 units, out of 11,529 Starlink satellites launched since 2019.
- Falcon 9 reusability, with boosters like B1088 on its 14th flight, enables a very high launch cadence.
- Starlink claims more than 10 million customers and is aiming to expand to 12,000 satellites, with the potential for more.
- The milestone has renewed criticism about orbital congestion and its impact on astronomy and the night sky.

Frequently Asked Questions

Why do people talk about 10,000 “active” satellites and not just launched ones?

Because SpaceX has launched more satellites in total than the number that are operational at any one time. Some satellites have been replaced, deorbited, or are no longer functional. The announced milestone refers to the number of units that are simultaneously present and active in low Earth orbit.

How many Starlink satellites are in orbit after the March 17, 2026 launch?

Orbital tracking sources cite a total of about 10,020 Starlink satellites in orbit after the Vandenberg launch that carried 25 satellites. Additional launches close in time can change this number, but the 10,000 threshold had been surpassed as of that date.

What role does Falcon 9 reusability play in Starlink's expansion?

Reusability makes it possible to increase launch cadence and reduce operating costs. On this mission, booster B1088 flew for the 14th time and landed on a droneship, helping keep stages available quickly for new launches.

Is Starlink really dominant compared with other constellations?

Yes. Estimates indicate Starlink accounts for about two-thirds of the active satellites currently in orbit. By comparison, OneWeb—often cited as the other major constellation—has 654 satellites, highlighting the gap in size and pace.

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What are the main criticisms related to the growing number of satellites?

Criticisms focus on congestion in low Earth orbit, collision risk, and impacts on astronomy, including visible streaks in some observations. Experts also point to governance concerns when a single actor concentrates a very large share of active objects in orbit.

Sources

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- [SpaceX reaches milestone of 10,000 Starlink satellites in orbit](#)
- [SpaceX launches 10,000th active Starlink satellite in low Earth orbit](#)
- [Starlink – Wikipedia](#)
- [SpaceX Falcon 9 rocket launches Starlink satellites from ...](#)

Il n'y a pas d'entrée similaire.

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